PwC Digital Strategy

Interview 09: Client Executive Sponsor

Responses to the open questions for the client | Project Meridian | 31 October 2026

Transcript status: Fictional practice transcript created to illustrate client responses; statements require validation. The Target, Market A, Market B and Project Meridian are placeholders. Nothing here is evidence about a real organisation, and the answers must not be treated as findings or verified facts.

Interview objective: Answer the eight open questions for the client raised in the partner-ready insight pack.

Interviewee: Client Executive Sponsor (fictional role). **Interviewer:** PwC Digital Strategy engagement team.

Transcript

Question 1: Scope

Interviewer: Which target, business model, countries and products are in scope for this engagement?

> **Stakeholder:** The target is a mid-sized medical technology company. For this exercise we are calling it "the Target" and the project "Project Meridian". It makes two lines of connected medical devices and sells a cloud-based monitoring platform that collects data from them. It currently operates in one market, which I will call Market A. The market we are considering entering is Market B.
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> I should be clear about what we know. That description comes from management's own presentation. We have not yet seen product-level detail, and I cannot yet tell you whether the platform is sold separately from the devices.

Interviewer: Do the devices and the platform need separate approvals?

> **Stakeholder:** I do not know. Our regulatory team has not confirmed the pathway for Market B. That is one of the things I would like your help establishing.

Question 2: Evidence so far

Interviewer: What has management already provided, and what has been independently verified?

> **Stakeholder:** Management has given us a presentation, summary financial information and a high-level regulatory overview. The data room has not been opened to us yet.
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> Nothing has been independently verified. We have no quality or complaint records, no inspection history, no system or data-flow documentation and no customer contracts. So everything we currently believe about the Target is management's account.

Question 3: Thresholds and gates

Interviewer: What are the client's investment thresholds, and who owns each decision gate?

> **Stakeholder:** The board has not approved investment thresholds. Our finance team intends to propose them, but I cannot give you numbers today.
>
> On ownership, my expectation is that the executive committee takes the final decision. I would expect the Chief Medical Officer and the Regulatory Director to be able to escalate a safety or compliance concern, and the CFO to own the financial gate. But that is my expectation. It has not been written down or agreed.

Interviewer: Would an escalation by the CMO or Regulatory Director stop the process, or only inform it?

Stakeholder: That has not been decided. It is a fair question and one we need to settle before diligence findings arrive.

Question 4: Alternatives

Interviewer: Is partnership or organic entry still under consideration, and by what criteria will it be compared with acquisition?

Stakeholder: Both are still open in principle. We have had an informal conversation about working with a local distributor in Market B, but nothing beyond that.

We have not set criteria for comparing the three routes. I accept that is a gap. At the moment the preference for acquisition rests on a belief that it is faster, and nobody has put a timeline against each option.

Question 5: Systems, data and AI

Interviewer: What does the client expect to do with the Target's systems, data and any AI opportunity, and who owns those decisions?

Stakeholder: There is interest in the data the monitoring platform collects, and in whether it could support analytics or AI services later. That is an aspiration, not a plan. We do not know what rights the Target has over that data, where it is stored, or whether it crosses borders.

We have not decided whether to integrate the Target's platform into our systems or keep it separate. The Chief Information Officer would lead that decision, with input from our data protection function. Neither has had access to the Target's systems yet.

Question 6: Integration

Interviewer: What integration approach is planned, and who has authority to stop a change that threatens safety or continuity?

Stakeholder: There is no integration plan. My own inclination is to change as little as possible early on, but that is a preference, not a commitment, and it has not been tested with the operations team.

Authority to stop a change is not defined. I would suggest it sits with whoever is accountable for quality, but we have not agreed who that would be after closing.

Question 7: Access to customers and reviewers

Interviewer: Which customers, partners and independent reviewers can we speak to, and when does confidentiality allow it?

Stakeholder: Contact with the Target's customers is not permitted at this stage. The Target's management has asked that customer outreach wait until a later phase and a firmer agreement between us. That is their position, and I have not seen it in writing.

Independent reviewers, such as quality and legal specialists, can be engaged through advisers, but only once the data room opens. For local partners, we may be able to hold conversations through a restricted team, subject to our legal advice.

Interviewer: Is there any way to hear customer views earlier, for example from our own customers in Market B?

Stakeholder: Possibly. Our own market team may have relevant views, but they would be about the market in general, not about the Target, and I would not want that treated as customer evidence about the Target.

Question 8: Timing

Interviewer: When does the executive committee decide, and what evidence must be ready by then?

Stakeholder: The decision is currently planned for the end of next quarter, although the date is not fixed. Papers would normally be needed a few weeks before.

On evidence, the committee will want to see what is verified and what is not. I would want a clear statement of the target's regulatory position, any quality or safety concerns, the technology and data picture, and a downside case. If we cannot verify something by then, I would rather the committee see it flagged than assumed.

Summary of client responses

This table restates what the client said. Every entry is a client statement and remains to be validated.

Question	Client response (statement, unvalidated)
Scope	The Target is a mid-sized medical technology company with connected devices and a monitoring platform, in Market A, with Market B under consideration; the regulatory pathway is not confirmed.
Evidence so far	Management presentation, summary financials and a regulatory overview received; nothing independently verified.
Thresholds and gates	Board thresholds not approved; gate ownership expected but not agreed; effect of escalation undecided.
Alternatives	Partnership and organic entry open; no comparison criteria or timelines set.
Systems, data and AI	Interest in platform data and possible AI; no plan; data rights unknown; integration decision undecided.
Integration	No integration plan; stop authority undefined.
Access to customers and reviewers	Customer contact not permitted yet; reviewers once data room opens; local partners possibly via restricted team.
Timing	Decision planned for the end of next quarter, not fixed; papers a few weeks earlier.

Follow-up evidence requests

- Request the original supporting document, dataset, contract, audit record, or source behind the statement.
- Ask for the country, product or service, time period, population or customer segment to which the claim applies.
- Ask what evidence could contradict the stakeholder's view and who else should be interviewed.

Note for the team

Several answers reduce uncertainty about the process, not about the Target. They confirm that no verification, thresholds, comparison criteria or integration plan exist yet. If the real client's answers differ from these illustrative ones, the insight pack's open questions should be updated accordingly.